Nicholas Rode

Motion Designer & Engineer

Contact

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Portfolio · Motion Reel

Skills

Motion & interaction
Rive (state machines, interactive components), After Effects, Lottie/Bodymovin, UI animation, micro-interactions, transitions, motion systems, visual storytelling, 2D/3D animation

Design
Figma (including motion), Illustrator, UI/UX design, design systems, interactive prototyping

Production & performance
Rive web runtimes (React, Canvas, WebGL2), Lottie JSON delivery, WebGL shaders, Lighthouse performance tuning, reduced-motion accessibility, developer handoff

AI workflow
Claude Code, AI-assisted prototyping and production code, Figma plugin and AI tool development

Education

Art Institute of Seattle
Nucamp, Full Stack Web Design 2020

Motion designer and engineer with 5+ years of experience shipping motion for B2B SaaS and tech brands. I turn complex products into clear, engaging motion and build it production-ready, fast, and accessible in Rive, Lottie, and code. An AI-first workflow lets me prototype, iterate, and ship faster, and I build my own tools to close the gap between design and development.

Experience

Motion Engineer, Webstacks — Jan 2025 – Present

B2B web design and development agency · Promoted from Motion Designer, Oct 2026

- Shipped interactive motion, animation, and illustration for Gong and Fireworks AI, including product UI motion for Fireworks AI
- Built 4 interactive Rive product demos for Deepgram's AI voice platform: voice-to-text, voice avatars, assistant states, and a Slack integration walkthrough
- Designed a 10-piece Rive motion system for Shep's rebrand and raised the hero's Lighthouse score from 40 to 99 by switching its Rive runtime from WebGL2 to Canvas
- Built AI-powered internal tools with Claude Code: a pipeline that turns After Effects renders into lightweight WebGL shaders and a Figma plugin that generates reliable React code
- Use AI daily to prototype interactions and write production animation code, speeding up design-to-dev handoff
- Choose and optimize animation runtimes for mobile web performance

Junior Designer (Product UI & Motion), Variable Medium — Jan 2021 – Dec 2024

- Designed the desktop and mobile peer-to-peer trading app for Evaluate, from interactive prototypes for user testing through launch, plus its marketing site and onboarding video
- Designed trade and chat flows, including asynchronous offers with expiry dates so traders don't need to be online at the same time
- Contributed to design system development and created motion that clarified complex product flows

Freelance Motion Designer & Illustrator, Self-employed — 2022 – Present

- Deliver motion graphics, illustration, and web and mobile design for tech, SaaS, and B2B clients

Tools I've Built

Stroke Center (Figma Community): Plugin that converts inside/outside strokes to center for clean Lottie export.

Design to Webpage: AI skill that turns Figma designs into working HTML prototypes with interactions and motion; used on client projects.

Courses

Rive Masterclass
TheMotionMagic, Ultimate Rive Animation Course
School of Motion, A Motion Design Masterpiece